
Even Donald Trump Is Taking Note of Hunter Biden's Online Rampage. I Have Concerns.

Published by

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Estimated reading time

5 min

Added on

2026-06-08

Address

<https://slate.com/life/2026/06/donald-trump-couldnt-help-but-respond-to-what-hunter-biden-is-doing-online.html>

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There's something so vintage about Hunter Biden's sudden Twitter spree. The son of former President Joe Biden rejoined the platform in May and this week started posting at a remarkable clip: 102 posts Monday, 85 on Tuesday, 74 on Wednesday, and so on. (These counts come courtesy of [People](#).) Circa 10 to 15 years ago, it seemed like hardly a day went by without a famous person joining Twitter and going viral for their "clapbacks," which would be celebrated by then-ascendant digital media outlets like BuzzFeed. Now Twitter/X and BuzzFeed are shells of their former selves, and celebrities tend to be a little more savvy about wading into the cesspool. But as someone who knows from cesspools—having survived addiction, immense personal loss, and the Republican Party—Hunter Biden apparently didn't flinch at the opportunity.

Biden's tweets have leaned into his status as an "ironic icon," [as the New York Times once called him](#), a [sleazy-hot](#) failson whose weakness for drugs and sex workers only makes him more lovable to certain demographics, namely progressive but disillusioned millennials and Gen Zers. A common theme in his posts has been candid and self-deprecating references to his struggle with substances. Biden's most widely circulated tweet this week was a reply to a user who demanded that he admit that [a bag of cocaine that was infamously found in the White House during Joe Biden's presidency](#) was his. "It most definitely was not," [the younger Biden wrote](#). "I would never have forgotten my drugs." In another reply, he clarified that cocaine was actually not his drug of choice. "And least get it right," [he wrote](#). "I smoked crack. I would never have wasted coke on snorting it."

Sometimes, these drug references were made in service of a point, like when Biden attempted to counter a user's suggestion that he is a member of the "elite oligarch class." [He responded](#) with a familiar photo of himself, shirtless and ciggy in mouth, from the long-ago [stolen laptop](#) that became a lightning rod during the first Trump administration. "Do I look like I'm part of the elite oligarch class. This was taken at a super 8 motel off I95 by the way," he wrote. Other posts, though, seemed to reference his past purely for the fun of it, like when he responded to a meme of himself with a pipe: "I know this may sound petty, but I can't stand it when people put photoshop a meth pipe in my mouth," [he wrote](#). "A crack pipe doesn't have that little bowl at the end. This is why we can't trust AI. Please make the appropriate edit. Thank you for your attention to this matter." (That end flourish, of course, is a reference to [a phrase President Trump often uses](#) on Truth Social.)

Elsewhere, Hunter [raged against CNN's Jake Tapper](#) and his criticism of the Biden family coupled with a relative disregard for the Trump family's corruption. He made several attempts to engage with trolls humanely, trying to find common ground with one who called his family "a disgrace" by pointing out that the user's profile picture was of Johnny Cash, someone who he also considered a hero. [He said](#) that Cash, like him, had brushes with the law and was a heavy drug user, but he got clean and "spent the rest of his life singing for prisoners and addicts and the people the country threw away because he knew he was one of them." It was a surprisingly lovely little note.

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Pretty much everyone online seems to be loving Hunter's Twitter era, responding with a familiar set of compliments: He's posting bangers, we're obsessed, he's out of fucks and we're here for it, etc. He's up to nearly half a million followers. This is all well and good and I agree to a point: Thanks for all the lols, Hunter.

But I kind of hope that sort of talk stops before he gets, to use a perhaps unfortunate metaphor, high on his own supply. Already, there have been [calls for him to run for president in 2028](#), calls that [Trump himself has responded to](#). (He, too, is obsessed.) We're seeing what happens when a handsome nepo baby with an erratic online persona runs for office right now with [Jack Schlossberg's campaign for Congress](#), and it hasn't been pretty. As charming and loveable as Hunter is, "really good poster" is a great lane for him to occupy, and we don't need to [Peter principle](#) him into the presidency.

Lest we forget, because it seems like everyone has, it's only been two weeks since Hunter Biden went onto the podcast of notorious antisemite and conspiracy theorist Candace Owens and [called her](#) "probably the most effective communicator I've ever heard behind the microphone." I think it was part of his project to make his foes see him as a human, but even so. His [defense of his father's 2024 campaign](#) similarly has been both understandable and ill-considered. We all need to slow our roll here. For all we know, Hunter will get tired of tweeting and drastically reduce his output—500 tweets a week would be a crazy pace to sustain. If that happens, at least we'll always be able look back on this week of glorious tweets like a decadent cigarette in a Super 8 motel off I-95: a moment in time in worth appreciating.

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